zsh + kitty Cheat Sheet

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For: MacBook Air M4, kitty 0.48, zsh 5.9 (emacs keymap), Homebrew plugins.

`kitty_mod` = **Ctrl+Shift** (kitty default). All defaults below apply unless you've rebound them in `~/.config/kitty/kitty.conf` (you only customized font-size keys).

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1. Daily-driver zsh shortcuts (emacs mode)

Your `~/.zshrc` line 73 sets `bindkey -e` — these are the bindings that matter.

Line editing

Key	Action
`Ctrl+A`	Move to start of line
`Ctrl+E`	Move to end of line
`Ctrl+B` / `F`	Move back / forward one char
`Esc` then `B` / `F`	Move back / forward one word
`Ctrl+D`	Delete char under cursor (or list completion)
`Ctrl+H`	Delete char before cursor (backspace)
`Ctrl+W`	Delete word before cursor
`Esc` then `D`	Delete word after cursor
`Ctrl+K`	Kill to end of line
`Ctrl+U`	Kill to start of line
`Ctrl+Y`	Yank back last killed text
`Ctrl+T`	Transpose two chars
`Ctrl+_`	Undo
`Ctrl+X Ctrl+U`	Undo (alternate)
`Ctrl+X Ctrl+X`	Jump between cursor and mark (toggle)
`Ctrl+Q`	Push current line aside (pop with `Ctrl+Q` again after next command)
`Ctrl+V <key>`	Insert next key literally

Delete key fix (already in your config, line 76–77)

- `Fn+Delete` (forward delete) works correctly
- `Ctrl+Fn+Delete` deletes a word forward

History

Key	Action
`Ctrl+R`	Incremental **reverse** history search (type to filter)
`Ctrl+S`	Incremental **forward** history search
`Ctrl+P` / `N`	Previous / next in history (or arrows)
`↑` / `↓`	**History-substring search** (type prefix, then arrow)
`Ctrl+O`	Accept line and advance to next history line

With `SHARE_HISTORY` (line 17), every running zsh shares history in real-time. `HIST_IGNORE_SPACE` (line 21) means a command starting with a space is **not** saved — prefix secrets with a space.

Completion (TAB)

Your `compinit -i` (line 114–115) gives you a fast menu-driven completer.

Key	Action
`TAB`	Complete / cycle through matches (`MENU_COMPLETE`)
`Ctrl+D`	List all possible completions

Key	Action
`Ctrl+X g`	List glob expansions
`Ctrl+X *`	Expand glob in place
`Ctrl+X a`	Expand alias
`Ctrl+X m`	Insert most-recent file matching what you typed
`Ctrl+X r`	History-incremental-search filenames

Completion is **case-insensitive** (line 39: `m:{a-zA-Z}={A-Za-z}`). `cd`/`cp`/etc. complete paths; `git` completes subcommands; `kubectl`, `docker`, `brew` all have their own.

Typed-cd and dir stack

Lines 47–56 enable these:

Input	Result
`Repos`	`cd Repos` (no `cd` needed, `AUTO_CD`)
`cd - TAB`	Pick from last 20 dirs (`AUTO_PUSHD`)
`dirs -v`	Show directory stack
`cd +2`	Jump to 3rd entry in stack

Command correction

`CORRECT` is on (line 63). For typos like `git satus`:

`zsh: correct 'satus' to 'status' [nyae]?`

Keys: `y` yes · `n` no · `a` abort · `e` edit.

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2. Your plugins — what they do and how to drive them

zsh-syntax-highlighting (loaded at line 124)

Live colors as you type — green command exists, red doesn't. Nothing to press; just look. Must load **before** autosuggestions (your config does this).

zsh-autosuggestions (loaded at line 135)

Gray ghost text appears to the right of your cursor.

Key	Action
`→` or `End`	Accept entire suggestion
`Ctrl+→`	Accept one word of suggestion
(any other)	Dismiss — keep typing

Set in `~/.zshrc` (optional, not yet set):

```
ZSH_AUTOSUGGEST_HIGHLIGHT_STYLE='fg=8'
ZSH_AUTOSUGGEST_STRATEGY=(history completion)
```

zsh-history-substring-search (loaded at line 146, bound at 157–158)

Key	Action
Type, then `↑`	Find previous command containing the substring

Key	Action
Type, then ↓	Find next command containing the substring
`Ctrl+U`	Abort search (returns to current line)

Unlike `Ctrl+R`, this lets you walk forward/back through every match without retyping. Case-insensitive by default.

z — directory jumping (loaded at line 163)

Tracks a "frecency" (frequency + recency) of everywhere you `cd`.

```
z zsh-setup        # jumps to ~/Repos/zsh-setup after you've been there once
z repo zsh         # match by path-segment
z -l zsh-setup     # list matches with scores
```

fzf — fuzzy finder (loaded at line 173)

Three shell-level bindings (active in your fzf install):

Key	Action
`Ctrl+R`	Fuzzy history search (replaces zsh's `Ctrl+R`)
`Ctrl+T`	Fuzzy file finder — pastes selected path at cursor
`Alt+C`	Fuzzy directory finder — `cd` into selection
`** TAB`	Fuzzy-complete any argument (e.g. `vim **<TAB>`)

Inside any fzf window:

Key	Action
`Ctrl+J` / `K`	Move down / up (or arrows)
`TAB`	Multi-select (with `-m`)
`Enter`	Accept
`Ctrl+C` / `Esc`	Cancel
`Ctrl+R`	(in history) Toggle chronological sort
`Alt+/`	Toggle line wrap

Search syntax (multiple terms separated by spaces):

Token	Meaning
`foo`	fuzzy match
`'foo`	exact match
`^foo`	prefix match
`foo$`	suffix match
`!foo`	inverse match
`|`	OR between terms

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3. Aliases you actually have

From your `~/.zshrc` lines 187–234.

General

`ll` `la` `l` · `...` (cd ../..) · `....` (cd ../../..)

Git

`gs` status · `gcm` commit -m · `gp` push · `gpl` pull · `gco` checkout · `gb` branch · `gd` diff · `gl` log oneline · `gla` log all graph

Docker (if installed)

`d` · `dc` compose · `dcu` up · `dcd` down

Kubernetes (if installed)

`k` · `kg` get · `kd` describe · `kl` logs · `kex` exec -it

Config

`zshconfig` (opens `~/.zshrc` in `$EDITOR` = `code --wait`) · `zshreload`

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4. Functions

From `~/.zshrc` lines 274–297.

```
mcd mydir           # mkdir + cd into it
extract file.tar.gz  # auto-detects tar/zip/rar/7z/gz/bz2/Z
```

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5. kitty keyboard shortcuts

Your `~/.config/kitty/kitty.conf` only customizes font sizes; everything else below is kitty default. `kitty_mod` = **Ctrl+Shift**.

Windows

Key	Action
`kitty_mod+Enter`	New window (splits current)
`kitty_mod+]` / `[`	Next / previous window
`kitty_mod+n`	New OS window
`kitty_mod+w`	Close window
`kitty_mod+r`	Resize window (then arrows/Esc)
`kitty_mod+f` / `b`	Move window forward / backward
`kitty_mod+\``	Move window to top | |kitty_mod+l| Next layout (stacked/tall/grid/fat/horizontal/vertical/...) | |kitty_mod+1...9‘	Jump to window N

Tabs

Key	Action
`kitty_mod+t`	New tab
`kitty_mod+q`	Close tab
`kitty_mod+right` / `left`	Next / previous tab
`kitty_mod+shift+right` / `left`	Move tab right / left
`kitty_mod+i` / `,`	Set tab title
`Ctrl+Shift+1 ... 9` (`kitty_mod+1 ... 9`)	Go to tab N

Font (your customizations)

Key	Action
`Cmd+plus`	Increase font size
`Cmd+minus`	Decrease font size
`Cmd+0`	Reset font size

Scrollback / clipboard

Key	Action
`kitty_mod+k` / `j`	Scroll line up / down (smooth)
`kitty_mod+page_up` / `page_down`	Scroll page up / down
`kitty_mod+home` / `end`	Scroll to top / bottom
`kitty_mod+z` / `x`	Previous / next shell prompt in scrollback
`kitty_mod+h`	Browse scrollback in pager
`kitty_mod+g`	Show last command output in pager
`kitty_mod+/`	Search scrollback
`kitty_mod+c`	Copy to clipboard
`kitty_mod+v`	Paste from clipboard
`kitty_mod+s`	Paste from primary selection
`kitty_mod+o`	Pass selection to external program

Mouse (kitty default)

Action	Result
`Cmd+click` on URL/path	Open it
`Shift+drag`	Select in app that grabbed mouse
Double-click	Select word
Triple-click	Select line
`Cmd+C` / `Cmd+V`	Standard macOS copy/paste

Misc kitty

Key	Action
`kitty_mod+F11`	Toggle fullscreen
`kitty_mod+F10`	Toggle kitty's own debug overlay
`kitty_mod+e`	Edit `kitty.conf` (opens in EDITOR)
`kitty_mod+u`	Enter Unicode input (kitten)
`kitty_mod+F2`	Run a kitten by name

Reload kitty config after edits: `Ctrl+Shift+F5` or `kill -SIGUSR1 $(pgrep kitty)`.

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6. macOS shell integration extras

Your `~/.zshrc` loads iTerm2 shell integration (line 334) — with kitty, the *mark-jump* and *last-command-output* features don't apply, but these kitty built-ins fill the gap and are more reliable:

- `kitty_mod+z` / `x` — jump between shell prompts in the scrollback (works because kitty auto-detects shell prompts)

- `kitty_mod+g` — open last command's output in pager

If you want pure kitty shell integration (recommended over iTerm2's), it's already enabled by default — see `kitty +kitten themes` and https://sw.kovidgoyal.net/kitty/shell-integration/.

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7. Workflow recipes

"Find that one git command I ran last week"

`Ctrl+R`, type a fragment, hit `Ctrl+R` again to cycle; press `→` to keep, `Enter` to run.

"Jump to the project I was in yesterday"

`z <fragment>` — if multiple match, `z -l <fragment>` shows scores first.

"Open a file I saw in the last commit, in VS Code"

```
code $(git diff --name-only HEAD~1 | fzf --multi)
```

"Grep across the repo and jump to a match"

```
rg --line-number . | fzf --delimiter : --nth 3.. \
    --bind 'enter:become(code -g {1}:{2}:{3})'
```

"Split kitty into 4 panes for a dev session"

`kitty_mod+Enter` three times, then `kitty_mod+l` to cycle layouts until Grid.

"Look at what just scrolled off"

`kitty_mod+g` to page through the last command's output, or `kitty_mod+h` for the full scrollback in `less`.

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8. Where things live

What	Path
zsh config	`~/.zshrc`
Local secrets	`~/.zshrc.local` (git-ignored)
Template (repo)	`~/Repos/zsh-setup/zshrc-template`
kitty config	`~/.config/kitty/kitty.conf`
kitty themes dir	`~/.config/kitty/themes/`
fzf install	`~/.fzf.zsh` + `~/.fzf/`
z data	`~/.z` (auto-created on first `cd`)
zsh history	`~/.zsh_history`
Completion cache	`~/.zcompdump*`

---

9. Troubleshooting cheat codes

Symptom	Fix
Compinit warning recurs	Ensure `~/.zshrc:114-115` uses `compinit -i`
New completion not picked up	`rm ~/.zcompdump* && exec zsh`
Ghost-suggestion color invisible	`export ZSH_AUTOSUGGEST_HIGHLIGHT_STYLE='fg=cyan'`
`↑` searches but skips duplicates	Expected: `HIST_FIND_NO_DUPS` is on (line 20)

Symptom	Fix
`Ctrl+R` shows fzf, not zsh	Expected — fzf replaced it (line 173)
`kitty_mod` shortcut doesn't fire	Check if app grabbed input; try `Shift+` variant
Paste mangled	`paste_actions` (line ~731 of kitty.conf)

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10. Sources (official docs)

- zsh manual — `man zsh` / `man zshzle` / `man zshcontrib`
- kitty docs — https://sw.kovidgoyal.net/kitty/
- kitty actions index — https://sw.kovidgoyal.net/kitty/actions/
- fzf — https://github.com/junegunn/fzf (run `fzf --man` for full options)
- zsh-autosuggestions — https://github.com/zsh-users/zsh-autosuggestions
- zsh-syntax-highlighting — https://github.com/zsh-users/zsh-syntax-highlighting
- zsh-history-substring-search — https://github.com/zsh-users/zsh-history-substring-search
- z (rupa/z) — https://github.com/rupa/z